Recommendations

Data-Driven Career Insights for Aspiring Analysts

🏆 CAREER PATH DECISION

Factor	Business Analyst	Data Analyst	Winner
Job Volume	3.650	2.251	🏆 BA
Avg Salary	$73.516	$78.762	🏆 DA
SQL Demand	30%	62%	—
Python Demand	8%	28%	—
Excel Demand	56%	60%	—

💡 RECOMMENDATION

Trade-off: **Business Analyst** has **more jobs**,
Data Analyst pays more.

➜ **More market opportunities** → Business Analyst
➜ **Higher technical skills** & **salary** → Data Analyst
➜ But **BA** pays more in **CA**, **NY** & **TX**

🎯 SKILLS TO PRIORITIZE

🎯 PRIORITY 1

Excel

Required in **57%** of all analyst positions, making it the most universally demanded skill across both roles.

Business Analysts (56%) and **Data Analysts (60%)** need it almost equally.

Excel *remains the foundation for data manipulation*, reporting, and business communication, even as more advanced tools grow in popularity.

🎯 PRIORITY 2

SQL

Required in **42%** of positions overall, but with a major gap between roles: **62%** for Data Analysts vs only **30%** for Business Analysts.

SQL is the gateway to working with databases and is increasingly non-negotiable for any data-focused career.

Prioritize this skill early, it has the highest demand among technical skills for DA roles.

🎯 PRIORITY 3

Python (DA) / Tableau (BA

The key differentiator for higher salary.

Python dominates Data Analyst roles (**28%**) and signals advanced analytical capability,
while Tableau is more prevalent in Business Analyst positions (**12%**) for dashboard creation and visual storytelling.

Investing in the right tool for your chosen path can set you apart from other candidates.

🌍 GEOGRAPHIC STRATEGY

📍 **Most Opportunities**
Texas, California, New York
TX: 1.706 • CA: 1.641 • NY: 600

💰 **Highest Salary**
California ($92K)
CA pays **22% above** national avg

⚖️ **Best Balance**
New York, Illinois, NJ
Good salary + diverse employers